STORY 4 New Words • The Lion Who Met Another King

1 **forest** ['fɒrɪst] *n.* — лес
A forest is a big place with very many trees.
→ We walked through the forest for two hours.

2 **afraid** [ə'freɪd] *adj.* — испуганный, боящийся
When you are afraid, you think that something bad will happen.
→ My little brother is afraid of dogs.

3 **hunt** [hʌnt] *v.* — охотиться
To hunt is to follow an animal and catch it.
→ Cats hunt at night.

4 **roar** [rɔ:] *v. / n.* — рычать; рык
To roar is to make a very loud, deep sound, like a lion.
→ The lion roared, and everybody ran.

5 **agree** [ə'gri:] *v.* — соглашаться
To agree is to say yes to an idea.
→ We all agreed to meet at six o'clock.

6 **turn** [tɜ:n] *n.* — очередь
Your turn is the time when you do something, after the other people.
→ Wait, please! It is my turn now.

7 **clever** ['klevə] *adj.* — умный, хитрый
A clever person or animal thinks quickly and finds good ideas.
→ That was a clever answer.

8 **hide** [haɪd] *v.* — прятаться, прятать
To hide is to go where other people cannot see you.
→ The boy hid behind the door.

9 **well** [wel] *n.* — колодец
A well is a deep hole in the ground with water at the bottom.
→ The village takes its water from an old well.

10 **deep** [di:p] *adj.* — глубокий
Something deep goes down a long way.
→ Be careful — the river is deep here.

11 **reflection** [rɪ'flekʃn] *n.* — отражение
Your reflection is the picture of you that you see in water or in a mirror.
→ She looked at her reflection in the shop window.

Useful phrases from the story

take turns — first one person, then the next one, then the next
The animals took turns and walked to the cave one by one.

keep a promise — to do the thing that you said you would do
For many weeks the lion kept his promise.

The Lion Who Met Another King

Long ago a lion lived in a big **forest**. Every animal there was **afraid** of him.

Every morning he came out of his cave and **roared**. The birds flew out of the trees. Then he went to **hunt**.

He did not hunt because he was hungry. He hunted because he could. Some days he caught five animals and ate only one.

One evening the animals met by the river. “In one year,” said the old bear, “this forest will be **empty**.” So they made a plan. In the morning they went to the lion together.

“King, stop **hunting** us,” said the bear. “Every day one animal will come to you. That animal will not run and will not **hide**. You will eat, and you will not touch the others.”

The lion thought about it. Hunting was hard work: running, waiting, lying in the wet grass. Food that walked to his door was easy food.

“And if one day nobody comes?” he asked. “Then you can eat all of us,” said the bear. The lion **agreed**, and both sides made a **promise**.

After that the animals took **turns**. The first day a big deer went. The second day a goat. The third day a young pig. Nobody ran, and nobody hid. Every animal knew its own day.

Then it was the **turn** of a rabbit. His name was Toshi. He was the smallest animal in the forest, and the most **clever**.

Toshi did not run away. He walked very slowly. He stopped at a little river and drank. For a moment he watched his own **reflection** in the water. Then he walked on.

The sun was high when he arrived. The lion was walking up and down, and his eyes were red. “You are late!” he **roared**. “And you are so small. Is this my dinner?”

“I am very sorry, King,” said Toshi. “Five rabbits left home this morning. On the road we met another lion. I have never seen an animal so big. He ate four of us. Then he said that he is the king of this forest now.”

The lion’s **roar** was so loud that the trees shook. “Where is he?” “He is **hiding**,” said Toshi. “Come with me.”

The rabbit took him to an old **well** in the forest. It was very **deep**. Far below there was cold black water. “He lives down there,” said Toshi quietly, “with my four brothers.”

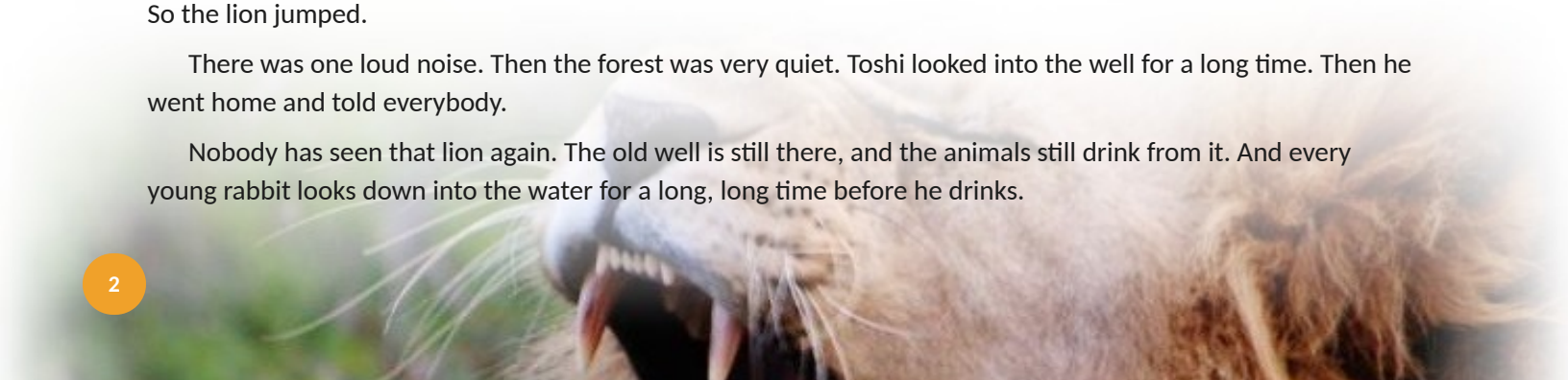
The lion put his head over the well and looked down. A big lion looked straight up at him. He opened his mouth. The lion in the water opened his mouth too.

He roared. A roar came back out of the well — deep, angry, and just as loud as his own.

“Come out and fight me!” he shouted. The other king did not come out. He waited down there in the water. So the lion jumped.

There was one loud noise. Then the forest was very quiet. Toshi looked into the well for a long time. Then he went home and told everybody.

Nobody has seen that lion again. The old well is still there, and the animals still drink from it. And every young rabbit looks down into the water for a long, long time before he drinks.



STORY 4 Exercises • The Lion Who Met Another King

A. Fill in the gaps. *Use the words from the box. Change the form if you need to.*

forest • afraid • hunt • roar • agree • turn • clever • hide • well • deep • reflection

1. Every animal in the _____ was afraid of the lion.
2. The lion _____ every morning, and the birds flew away.
3. The animals were _____ of the lion, so they made a plan.
4. The lion _____ to the plan, and he stopped hunting.
5. One animal came every day, so the animals took _____ .
6. Toshi was the smallest animal, but he was very _____ .
7. Toshi said that the other lion was _____ in an old _____ .
8. The well was very _____ , and the water was far below.
9. In the water the lion saw his own _____ .
10. A lion does not _____ when his food walks to his door.

B. True or False? *Circle T or F.*

1	The lion hunted only when he was hungry.	T / F
2	The animals promised that one animal would come to the lion every day.	T / F
3	The lion did not agree with the animals' plan.	T / F
4	Toshi walked to the cave very slowly.	T / F
5	Toshi really met another lion on the road.	T / F
6	The lion jumped into the well.	T / F



C. Think and write.

1. The lion was big and strong, and Toshi was small. So why did Toshi win? Write two or three sentences.

2. Toshi stopped at the river on the way to the cave and looked at the water. Why is that important later in the story?

D. Translate into English.

Careful with the tense: Yesterday… → past simple. never / since that day / for many weeks → present perfect.

1. Вчера лев съел козу.
2. Я никогда не видел такого большого животного.
3. Все животные в лесу боялись короля.
4. Кролик был маленьким, но очень умным.
5. Никто не видел этого льва с того дня.

E. Translate into Russian.

1. The lion agreed, and both sides made a promise.
2. Have you ever looked at your reflection in a well?
3. The animals took turns and walked to the cave one by one.
4. He has kept his promise for many weeks.
5. Toshi did not run away, and he did not hide.

TEACHER PAGE • Story 4: The Lion Who Met Another King — not for students

A. Gaps

1. **forest** • 2. **roared** • 3. **afraid** • 4. **agreed** • 5. **turns** • 6. **clever** • 7. **hiding / well** • 8. **deep** • 9. **reflection** • 10. **hunt**

B. True or False

1. **False — he hunted because he could, and he left food on the grass.**
2. **True**
3. **False — he agreed, because easy food is better than hard work.**
4. **True**
5. **False — there was no other lion. He invented him.**
6. **True**

C. Think and write

1. Open. The strongest answer: Toshi used the lion's own anger and his own face against him. The lion could not think — he only wanted to fight. Accept any answer the student can support from the text (the slow walk, the story about five rabbits, the well, the roar coming back).

2. Open. He had already seen his own reflection that morning, so he knew what the lion would see in the well. That is where the plan came from. Accept any answer with this idea.

D. Into English

1. **Yesterday the lion ate a goat.**
2. **I have never seen such a big animal. / I have never seen an animal so big.**
3. **All the animals in the forest were afraid of the king.**
4. **The rabbit was small, but (he was) very clever.**
5. **Nobody has seen that lion since that day.**

E. Into Russian

1. **Лев согласился, и обе стороны дали обещание.**
2. **Ты когда-нибудь смотрел на своё отражение в колодце?**
3. **Животные ходили по очереди и приходили к пещере по одному.**
4. **Он держит своё обещание уже много недель.**
5. **Тоши не убежал и не спрятался.**

TEACHER PAGE • Story 4 — measurements and teaching notes

Measurements

Difficulty score	**115.0** (target for story 4: 115.8)
Story length	543 words in 75 sentences • average sentence 7.2 words
New words taught	11
Words beyond top-1000	3.5% of the story
Grammar in this story	**Past simple + present perfect.** Past simple carries the whole story. The present perfect appears only twice, and both times it is the natural choice: *I have never seen an animal so big* (Toshi's lie — life experience, no time given) and *Nobody has seen that lion again* (a result that is still true today). Also: future simple in the animals' offer (*one animal will come*), *can / could not*, and present simple in the last paragraph.
Recycled from earlier	*empty* (Story 2) and *promise* (Story 1) — both used inside the text, not re-taught

Teaching notes

- **Stop before the well.** Read to "Toshi said that the other lion was hiding. Come with me." Ask the class: where is he taking the lion, and why? Let them guess before you read on.
- **The planted clue.** Toshi looks at his own reflection in the river on the way. Ask who noticed it the first time. That is the whole plan, hidden in one sentence.
- **Present perfect vs past simple** is the grammar point of page 4. The rule to give: *past simple = we say when; present perfect = we do not say when, and it still matters now.*
- **Retelling in six steps:** the lion hunts → the animals make a deal → one animal a day → the rabbit comes late → "another king" → the well.
- **Speaking.** Was the rabbit fair? Is being clever better than being strong? Have you ever won against somebody bigger than you?
- **Words to drill for speech:** afraid, agree, turn, clever, hide. The others they only need to recognise.